

the “Allow Comments” box to disable comments – this isn’t recommended, though it’s a personal choice.

Discussion settings

a. Your default article / post settings are visible which basically allow comments, pingbacks and trackbacks.

‘Comments’ is easily understandable. You’ll need to read up on pingbacks and trackbacks if you wish to fully understand the two (there is documentation available on the web). A nice simple explanation of a “trackback” available on the web was this :

- Person A writes something on their blog.
- Person B wants to comment on Person A's blog, but wants her own readers to see what she had to say, and be able to comment on her own blog
- Person B posts on her own blog and sends a trackback to Person A's blog
- Person A's blog receives the trackback, and displays it as a comment to the original post. This comment contains a link to Person B's post

Pingbacks are similar, except they don’t allow content (like the author’s own comments) and instead only have the link. They use a different protocol and have a layer of authenticity. Most of us just ignore this. Ensure you have pingbacks and trackbacks enabled, the rest WordPress will take care of.

b. As we discussed earlier, the above can be overridden for individual articles

c. Usually, most people don’t prefer Anonymous comments. Though anonymity on the web is useful and often essential, you may wish to know the identity of the commenter (or a way to contact him). Hence, the author must fill out a name and e-mail address (of course, if he really wanted to, he could fake both)

d. Wanting users to register does not make sense for a personal blog. For that matter, it makes commenting an extremely tiresome process which might lead to your readers not doing so.

e. You can disable comments on older posts after a fixed period of time

f. Nested comments help with conversations. If someone has commented on your post, and someone replies to that comment, it creates a mini-conversation of sorts. Now, someone can comment on the comment. You may choose how deep this runs. Sites like Reddit have layers of conversations which often leaves you wondering what started the entire comment. This is an example of how blogs act like ad-hoc forums

g. Depending on how much you care about your blog and the type of